Little Fox Readers

Level 5

Journey to the West 21

The Monster's Friend



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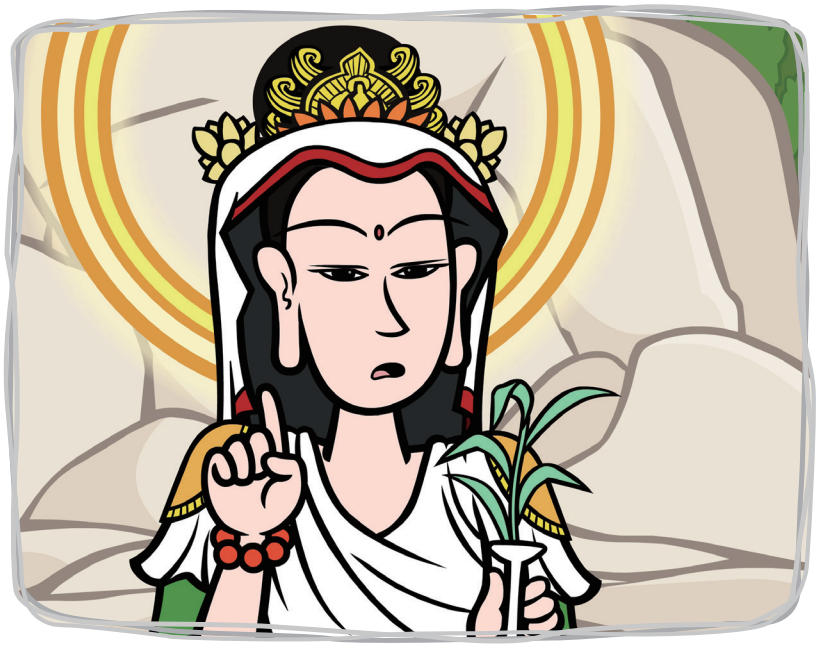


Little Fox



Wukong stood before Guanyin. He was telling the bodhisattva everything that had happened at the monastery.

"Then a bear spirit called the Black Wind King stole the robe," the monkey went on. "I demanded he give it back. We fought—until the bear spirit said it was lunchtime and hid in his cave. I kicked the door and yelled insults at him for more than an hour. But he



wouldn't come out. You must help me."

Guanyin sighed. "The Tang Monk should not have shown that robe to the priest," she said. "The robe is a Buddhist treasure. When other people see it, they will want it. And as that head priest tried to do, they might harm the Tang Monk."

"I agree," said Wukong. "I've told the Tang Monk many times not to do dumb



things. But still he—”

“And you should have put out that fire,” Guanyin said, interrupting Wukong. “What you did was terrible!”

Wukong looked at the ground. He kicked a pebble. “I know,” he mumbled.

“I’ll help you get back the robe,” said Guanyin. “Let’s go.”

Wukong and Guanyin soared over the



ocean. Soon they landed on the mountain.

“Where is the Black Wind King’s cave?” asked Guanyin.

“It’s close,” said Wukong. “We should sneak up to it.”

They heard footsteps coming closer. Wukong and Guanyin hid as a Daoist priest walked along the path. The priest was holding a tray. A bright purple pill sat on the



tray.

The priest was talking to himself. “This is an exciting day,” he said. “The Black Wind King has a new robe that is a Buddhist treasure. And I hope he likes the pill I made for him. It will make him live forever.”

Wukong stared at the priest, using his magic sight.

“That’s not a priest!” Wukong realized.



“It’s a wolf spirit dressed as a priest.” The monkey’s eyes lit up. “I have an idea, Bodhisattva!”

A little while later, the priest stood before the Black Wind King’s cave door. He knocked and the door flew open.

“Are you still here, you little monkey?” shouted the Black Wind King. Then he saw the priest and smiled. “Oh, it’s you, my old



friend! Sorry for yelling. A pesky monkey spirit was here a little while ago." He looked around. "I guess he's gone."

"A monkey spirit was here?" asked the priest.

"Yes," said the bear. "He kept banging on my door and yelling at me. He was very rude."

The Black Wind King patted the priest on



the shoulder. "But let's not talk about him. It's good to see you. How have you been?"

"I'm well," said the priest. "I brought you a gift, to celebrate your new Buddhist treasure." He held up the tray with the pill.

The Black Wind King looked interested. "What kind of pill is that?"

"It is a very special pill," said the priest with a smile. "I made it just for you. It will



make you live forever."

The Black Wind King stroked his chin. "You know, I was just thinking this morning that I would like to live forever."

The bear picked up the pill and opened his mouth wide. As he brought the pill up to his mouth, the pill wiggled. "Huh? Did the pill just—"

But before the Black Wind King could



finish speaking, the pill hopped off his hand. It shot into his mouth and slid down his throat.

Gulp!